MARXIST APPROACH AND THE MODERN WORLD SYSTEM THEORY

The Marxists theory has not been able to secure a formidable place within the discipline of international relations. Mostly, Marxist discussion is confined to the question of 'imperialism' and one-sided interpretation of the phenomena. Marxism's emphasis on economic factors at the international level also has not been very successful in explaining the political, ideological and security issues falling within the domain of international relations. Therefore, Marxism has faced great difficulties in carving a niche for itself in the realm of IR theories. Karl Marx did not provide a theory of international relations, but in his works with Engels, for example, *Manifesto of the Communist Party* (1848), or his legendary work *Capital: A Critique of Political Economy (Das Capital,* originally published in 1867), there is reference to wars, proletarian internationalism, world revolution, expansion of capitalism on a world scale leading to a revolutionary socio-economic transformation and the like. Later, Lenin, Stalin, Mao, and a host of other communist scholars tried to elaborate Marx's views according to the changing needs of time and world scenario with an ardent effort to explain the events of international relations with the help of the principles propounded by him.

Basic Assumptions of Marxian Approach

1. Economic or materialistic determination provides a clue to understand international relations.
2. Historical determination provides a guideline to understand international relations.
3. The centrality of the concept of class and class struggle is evident in international relations.
4. The capitalist states seek economic exploitation and political subjugation of the weaker states.
5. A scramble for colonies follows.
6. Wars erupt as a result of the clash between capitalist nations themselves in their bid to establish colonies. The First World War (1914–1918) is a glaring example in this context.